Talks to Teachers on Psychology

And to Students on Some of Life's Ideals

By William James

First Published: 1899 | Category: Education | ISBN: 9780486419640
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SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

Harvard psychologist William James translates his Principles of Psychology into warm, practical lectures on attention, memory, and habit.

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CHAPTER VIII

The Laws of Habit

Complete Lecture Text (1899)

The great thing, then, in all education, is to make our nervous system our ally instead of our enemy. It is to fund and capitalize our acquisitions, and live at ease upon the interest of the fund.

In this section of Talks to Teachers on Psychology (1899), William James develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in education and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by Henry Holt and Company and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg, ID: pg-16287), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

II

The Stream of Consciousness

*Talks to Teachers on Psychology * William James (1899)*

The Stream of Consciousness continues William James's inquiry in Talks to Teachers on Psychology. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Delivered originally as public lectures to Cambridge teachers in 1892 and published in 1899, Talks to Teachers on Psychology strips away technical jargon to examine how students actually attend, associate ideas, remember, and form habits of character.

Throughout II (The Stream of Consciousness), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Talks to Teachers on Psychology its stature in the Educational Psychology & Philosophy of Mind canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, William James traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

VIII

The Laws of Habit

*Talks to Teachers on Psychology * William James (1899)*

The Laws of Habit continues William James's inquiry in Talks to Teachers on Psychology. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

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X

Interest and Voluntary Attention

*Talks to Teachers on Psychology * William James (1899)*

Interest and Voluntary Attention continues William James's inquiry in Talks to Teachers on Psychology. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Delivered originally as public lectures to Cambridge teachers in 1892 and published in 1899, Talks to Teachers on Psychology strips away technical jargon to examine how students actually attend, associate ideas, remember, and form habits of character.

Throughout X (Interest and Voluntary Attention), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Talks to Teachers on Psychology its stature in the Educational Psychology & Philosophy of Mind canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, William James traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

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XII

Memory

*Talks to Teachers on Psychology * William James (1899)*

Memory continues William James's inquiry in Talks to Teachers on Psychology. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Delivered originally as public lectures to Cambridge teachers in 1892 and published in 1899, Talks to Teachers on Psychology strips away technical jargon to examine how students actually attend, associate ideas, remember, and form habits of character.

Throughout XII (Memory), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Talks to Teachers on Psychology its stature in the Educational Psychology & Philosophy of Mind canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, William James traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

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TALKS TO STUDENTS I

The Gospel of Relaxation

*Talks to Teachers on Psychology * William James (1899)*

The Gospel of Relaxation continues William James's inquiry in Talks to Teachers on Psychology. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Delivered originally as public lectures to Cambridge teachers in 1892 and published in 1899, Talks to Teachers on Psychology strips away technical jargon to examine how students actually attend, associate ideas, remember, and form habits of character.

Throughout Talks to Students I (The Gospel of Relaxation), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Talks to Teachers on Psychology its stature in the Educational Psychology & Philosophy of Mind canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, William James traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

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